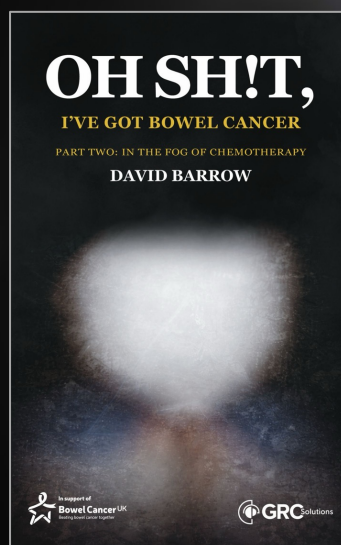
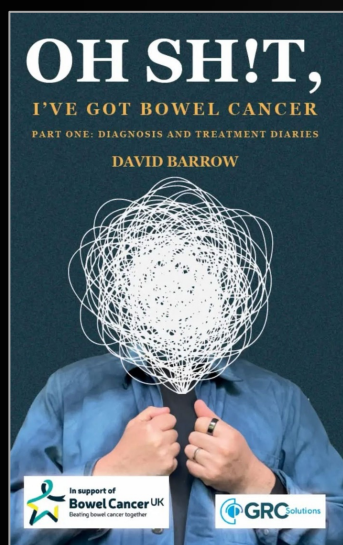


PART TWO

OH SH!T, I'VE GOT BOWEL CANCER

In the fog of chemotherapy



DAVID BARROW

7 raw truths from the chemo chair

SWIPE →

Fizzy hands. Frozen eyes.

Wrapped up like the SAS, all you could see was my eyes — and even they froze together three times on the walk. I had to use my hands to unstick my eyelids.

Hands, feet, cheeks, even a fizzy right bum cheek. Cold metal became untouchable. Strawberries fizzed in my mouth. It's 7° outside, but it feels like sub-zero.

SWIPE →

“

The worst day
I've had
mentally.

I'm on the verge of crying. I feel like I've gotten old overnight — lost my fitness, lost my spark.

And yet — writing to you, the reader, is what pulled me through.

SWIPE →

Surgery? Sign me up.

*“We thought surgery was bad.
Well, chemo was that — with bells on.”*

Post-op, I could name the pain, take the drugs, walk it off, and feel fitness creeping back.

Chemo is different. I don't know how long these side effects will stay. I don't know if they'll improve or get worse. I'm learning along with you.

SWIPE →

Aperol Shitz & a creamy curse.

THE ORANGE TRUTH

Orange poop — “Aperol Shitz,” as my friend Sophie christened it.

Horrible, stinky, but f&*king triumphant: it felt like clearing the toxins out.

PIZZA, RUINED

BBQ chicken pizza with balsamic onions.
Second bite: milk. Sandwich: milk. Wine: milk.
Everything tastes like my grandma's rice pudding.

(Sorry, Grandma.)

I now physically detest pizza.

SWIPE →

Football.

The real medicine.

LIVERPOOL

24/25 League champions. Every goal, every match, and a radio commentary on the drive to Congleton — Liverpool gave me a reason to keep going.

DORKING WANDERERS

Unlucky in the playoff, but Mark, Kris and the club showed up for me.

Is 25/26 The Wanderers' year?

“Watching the mighty Dorking Wanderers against Torquay from a chemo-wrecked bed, wearing gloves to touch the cutlery. This is the new normal.”

SWIPE →

Running the Isle of Wight.

FOR BOWEL CANCER UK

6 months before diagnosis, I ran 32 miles through the Sussex hills, carrying a tumour I didn't know was there.

When this SH!T is over, I'm coming back — and this time, I'm lacing up the trainers give something back.

Buy the book. Share your story.

A portion of every copy supports Bowel Cancer UK.

[Buy the book here](#)